

When that I say the city-woman bears
 The cost of princes on unworthy shoulders?
 Who can come in and say that I mean her,
 When such a one as she such is her neighbour?
 Or what is he of basest function
 That says his bravery is not on my cost,
 Thinking that I mean him, but therein suits
 His folly to the mettle of my speech?
 There then. How then, what then? Let me see wherein
 My tongue hath wronged him. If it do him right,
 Then he hath wronged himself. If he be free,
 Why then my taxing like a wild goose flies
 Unclaimed of any man.

(Enter ORLANDO, brandishing a sword)

But who comes here?

ORLANDO

Forbear, and eat no more.

JACQUES

Why, I have eat none yet.

ORLANDO

Nor shalt not till necessity be served.

JACQUES

Of what kind should this cock come of?

DUKE SENIOR

(To ORLANDO)

Art thou thus boldened, man, by thy distress,
 Or else a rude despiser of good manners,
 That in civility thou seem'st so empty?

ORLANDO
 You touched my vein at first. The thorny point
 Of bare distress hath ta'en from me the show
 Of smooth civility, yet am I inland bred
 And know some nurture. But forbear, I say.
 He dies that touches any of this fruit
 Till I and my affairs are answered.

JACQUES

An you will not be answered with reason, I must die.

DUKE SENIOR

(To ORLANDO)

What would you have? Your gentleness shall force
 More than your force move us to gentleness.

ORLANDO

I almost die for food, and let me have it.

DUKE SENIOR

Sit down and feed, and welcome to our table.

ORLANDO

Speak you so gently? Pardon me, I pray you.
 I thought that all things had been savage here,
 And therefore put I on the countenance
 Of stern commandment. But what'er you are
 That in this desert inaccessible,
 Under the shade of melancholy boughs,
 Lose and neglect the creeping hours of time,
 If ever you have looked on better days,
 If ever been where bells have knolled to church,
 If ever sat at any good man's feast,
 If ever from your eyelids wiped a tear
 And know what 'tis to pity and be pitied,
 Let gentleness my strong enforcement be,
 In the which hope I blush and hide my sword.

(He sheaths his sword.)

DUKE SENIOR

True is it that we have seen better days,
And have with holy bell been knolled to church,
And sat at good men's feasts and wiped our eyes
Of drops that sacred pity hath engendered.
And therefore sit you down in gentleness,
And take upon command what help we have
That to your wanting may be ministered.

ORLANDO

Then but forbear your food a little while
Whiles, like a doe, I go to find my fawn
And give it food. There is an old poor man
Who after me hath many a weary step
Limped in pure love. Till he be first sufficed,
Oppressed with two weak evils, age and hunger,
I will not touch a bit.

DUKE SENIOR

Go find him out,
And we will nothing waste till you return.

ORLANDO

I thank you; and be blessed for your good comfort.
(Exit ORLANDO.)

DUKE SENIOR

Thou seest we are not all alone unhappy.
This wide and universal theatre
Presents more woeful pageants than the scene
Wherein we play in.

Of all opinion that grows rank in them

That I am wise. I must have liberty
Withal, as large a charter as the wind,
To blow on whom I please, for so fools have.
And they that are most galled with my folly,
They most must laugh. And why, sir, must they so?
The 'why' is plain as way to parish church:
He that a fool doth very wisely hit
Doth very foolishly, although he smart,
Not to seem senseless of the bob. If not,
The wise man's folly is anatomized
Even by the squand'ring glances of the fool.
Invest me in my motley. Give me leave
To speak my mind, and I will through and through
Cleanse the foul body of th' infected world,
If they will patiently receive my medicine.

DUKE SENIOR

Fie on thee! I can tell what thou wouldst do.

JACQUES

What, for a counter, would I do but good?

DUKE SENIOR

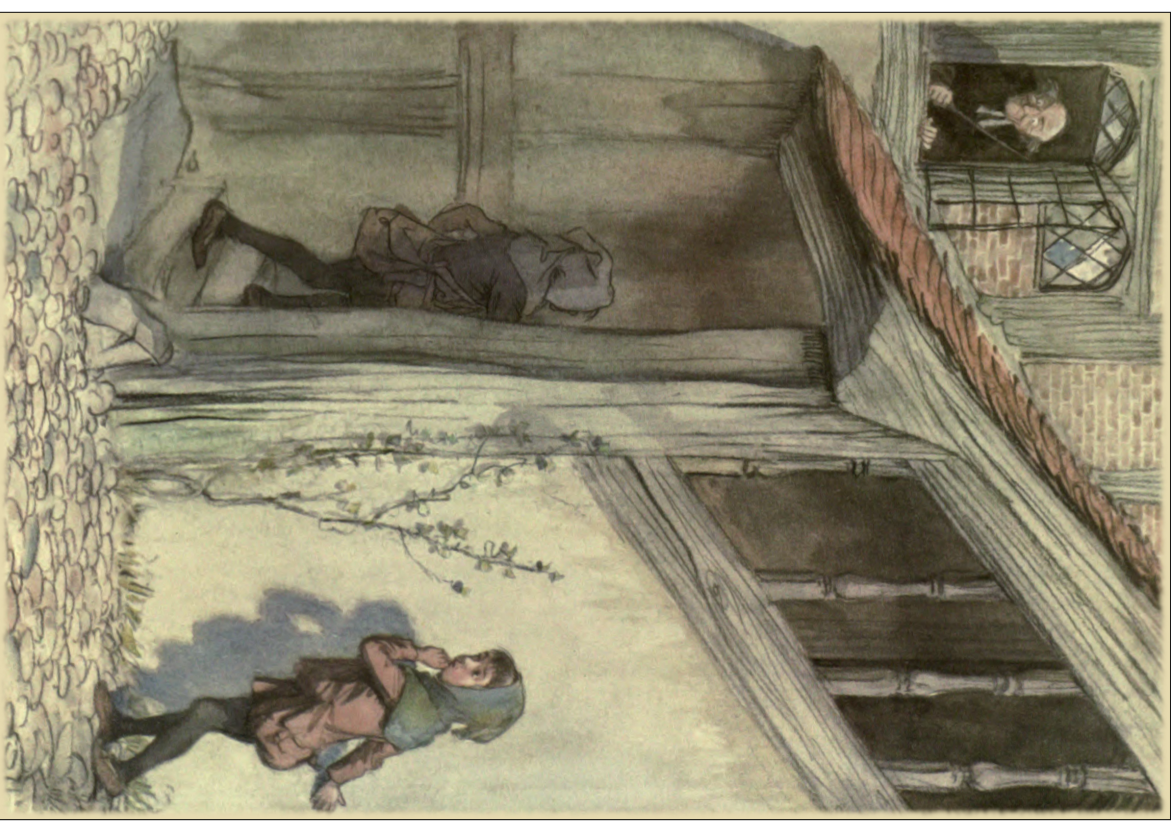
Most mischievous foul sin in chiding sin;
For thou thyself hast been a libertine,
As sensual as the brutish sting itself,
And all th' embossed sores and headed evils
That thou with license of free foot hast caught
Wouldst thou disgorge into the general world.

JACQUES

Why, who cries out on pride
That can therein tax any private party?
Doth it not flow as hugely as the sea
Till that the weary very means do ebb?
What woman in the city do I name



IF LADIES BE BUT YOUNG AND FAIR



CREEPING LIKE SNAIL UNWILLINGLY TO SCHOOL

JACQUES

All the world's a stage,
And all the men and women merely players.
They have their exits and their entrances,
And one man in his time plays many parts,
His acts being seven ages. At first the infant,
Mewling and puking in the nurse's arms.
Then the whining schoolboy with his satchel
And shining morning face, creeping like snail
Unwillingly to school. And then the lover,
Sighing like furnace, with a woeful ballad
Made to his mistress' eyebrow. Then a soldier,
Full of strange oaths and bearded like the pard,
Jealous in honour, sudden and quick in quarrel,
Seeking the bubble reputation
Even in the cannon's mouth. And then the justice,
In fair round belly with good capon lined,
With eyes severe and beard of formal cut,
Full of wise saws and modern instances;
And so he plays his part. The sixth age shifts
Into the lean and slippered pantaloon
With spectacles on nose and pouch on side,
His youthful hose, well saved, a world too wide
For his shrunk shank, and his big manly voice,
Turning again toward childish treble, pipes
And whistles in his sound. Last scene of all,
That ends this strange eventful history,
Is second childishness and mere oblivion,
Sans teeth, sans eyes, sans taste, sans everything.
(Enter ORLANDO, carrying ADAM)

DUKE SENIOR

Welcome. Set down your venerable burden,
And let him feed.



THUS WE MAY SEE HOW THE WORLD WAGS

‘Good morrow, fool,’ quoth I. ‘No, sir,’ quoth he,
‘Call me not “fool” till heaven hath sent me fortune.’

And then he drew a dial from his poke
And, looking on it with lack-luster eye,
Says very wisely ‘It is ten o’clock.

Thus we may see,’ quoth he, ‘how the world wags.

’Tis but an hour ago since it was nine,

And after one hour more ’twill be eleven.

And so from hour to hour we ripe and ripe,

And then from hour to hour we rot and rot,

And thereby hangs a tale.’ When I did hear

The motley fool thus moral on the time,

My lungs began to crow like chanticleer

That fools should be so deep-contemplative,

And I did laugh sans intermission

An hour by his dial. O noble fool!

A worthy fool! Motley’s the only wear.

DUKE SENIOR

What fool is this?

JACQUES

O worthy fool!—One that hath been a courtier,
And says ‘If ladies be but young and fair,

They have the gift to know it.’ And in his brain,

Which is as dry as the remainder biscuit

After a voyage, he hath strange places crammed

With observation, the which he vents

In mangled forms. O, that I were a fool!

I am ambitious for a motley coat.

DUKE SENIOR

Thou shalt have one.

JACQUES

It is my only suit,

Provided that you weed your better judgments

ORLANDO

I thank you most for him.

ADAM

So had you need.—

I scarce can speak to thank you for myself.

DUKE SENIOR

Welcome. Fall to. I will not trouble you

As yet to question you about your fortunes.—

Give us some music, and, good cousin, sing.

(*THE DUKE and ORLANDO continue their conversation, apart.*)

AMIENS

(*Sings*)

Blow, blow, thou winter wind.

Thou art not so unkind

As man’s ingratitude.

Thy tooth is not so keen,

Because thou art not seen,

Although thy breath be rude.

Heigh-ho, sing heigh-ho, unto the green holly.

Most friendship is feigning, most loving mere folly.

Then heigh-ho, the holly.

This life is most jolly.

Freeze, freeze, thou bitter sky,

That dost not bite so nigh

As benefits forgot.

Though thou the waters warp,

Thy sting is not so sharp

As friend remembered not.

Heigh-ho, sing heigh-ho, unto the green holly.

Most friendship is feigning, most loving mere folly.

As You Like It

*Then heigh-ho, the holly.
This life is most jolly.*

DUKE SENIOR

(To ORLANDO)

If that you were the good Sir Rowland's son,
As you have whispered faithfully you were,
And as mine eye doth his effigies witness
Most truly limned and living in your face,
Be truly welcome hither. I am the duke
That loved your father. The residue of your fortune
Go to my cave and tell me.—Good old man,
Thou art right welcome as thy master is.

(To LORDS)

Support him by the arm.

(To ORLANDO)

Give me your hand,
And let me all your fortunes understand.

(Exit omnes.)

Scene 7

The Forest of Arden

(Enter DUKE SENIOR and LORDS, like outlaws)

DUKE SENIOR

I think he be transformed into a beast,
For I can nowhere find him like a man.

FIRST LORD

My lord, he is but even now gone hence.
Here was he merry, hearing of a song.

DUKE SENIOR

If he, compact of jays, grow musical,
We shall have shortly discord in the spheres.
Go seek him. Tell him I would speak with him.

(Enter JAQUES.)

FIRST LORD

He saves my labour by his own approach.

DUKE SENIOR

(To JAQUES)

Why, how now, monsieur? What a life is this
That your poor friends must woo your company?
What, you look merrily.

JAQUES

A fool, a fool, I met a fool i' th' forest,
A motley fool. A miserable world!
As I do live by food, I met a fool,
Who laid him down and basked him in the sun
And railed on Lady Fortune in good terms,
In good set terms, and yet a motley fool.



BLOW, BLOW, THOU WINTER WIND

Scene 6

The Forest of Arden

(Enter ORLANDO and ADAM.)

ADAM

Dear master, I can go no further. O, I die for food. Here lie I down and measure out my grave. Farewell, kind master.

(He lies down.)

ORLANDO

Why, how now, Adam? No greater heart in thee? Live a little, comfort a little, cheer thyself a little. If this uncouth forest yield anything savage, I will either be food for it or bring it for food to thee. Thy conceit is nearer death than thy powers. For my sake, be comfortable. Hold death awhile at the arm's end. I will here be with thee presently, and if I bring thee not something to eat, I will give thee leave to die. But if thou diest before I come, thou art a mocker of my labour. Well said. Thou look'st cheerly, and I'll be with thee quickly. Yet thou liest in the bleak air.

Come, I will bear thee to some shelter, and thou shalt not die for lack of a dinner if there live anything in this desert. Cheerly, good Adam.

(Exeunt omnes.)